ascentium

Startup toolkit

Singapore

Setting up and running a private limited company (Pte. Ltd.) in Singapore.

Inside: the company at a glance · your first 90 days · the annual compliance calendar · are you an SME? · the documents to gather · how Ascentium helps

Mock toolkit prepared for a concept prototype. Not legal, tax or financial advice.
Information as at November 2026. Verify figures with the relevant authority before relying on them.

1. Your company at a glance

Item	What applies
Entity	Private company limited by shares (Pte. Ltd.)
Registry	Accounting and Corporate Regulatory Authority (ACRA), via BizFile+
Directors	At least one director who is ordinarily resident in Singapore
Company secretary	Must be appointed within six months of incorporation
Share capital	From S$1
Registered office	A Singapore address (not a P.O. box)
Government fees	S$15 name application and S$300 incorporation
Tax	Corporate income tax administered by IRAS; GST registration is compulsory above S$1 million of taxable turnover

Good to know

Foreign founders without a resident director commonly use a nominee director until a local director is appointed.

2. Your first 90 days

Tick these off in order. Your Ascentium dashboard tracks each one and Ascentia will remind you before anything falls due.

- ☐ **Reserve the name and incorporate**
  File through BizFile+ and receive your UEN and business profile.
- ☐ **Appoint a company secretary**
  Required within six months; we act as your secretary from day one.
- ☐ **Open a business account**
  Bring your incorporation documents and KYC for directors and shareholders.
- ☐ **Set your financial year-end**
  This drives every later deadline, from ECI to the annual return.
- ☐ **Keep registers up to date**
  Members, directors, controllers and nominee directors.
- ☐ **Check GST**
  Track taxable turnover against the S$1 million threshold.
- ☐ **Hiring?**
  Register for CPF contributions for Singapore citizens and permanent residents.

3. Annual compliance calendar

The recurring obligations most small private companies meet each year. Exact dates depend on your financial year-end and on notices issued by the authorities.

Obligation	When	Authority
Estimated Chargeable Income (ECI)	Within 3 months of financial year-end	IRAS
Annual General Meeting	Within 6 months of year-end (may be dispensed with)	ACRA
Annual return	Within 7 months of year-end	ACRA
Form C-S / C-S (Lite) / C	30 November each year	IRAS
GST F5 return	One month after each accounting period, if registered	IRAS
Employee income (IR8A / AIS)	1 March each year	IRAS

4. Are you an SME?

Enterprise Singapore treats a business as an SME if its group annual sales turnover is not more than S$100 million or its group employment is not more than 200 workers. Many grants also require at least 30% local shareholding.

Ascentium SME pricing

If your company, assessed together with any linked group companies, meets the official SME definition above, you qualify for Ascentium SME fares and the AI platform. Larger groups are served by Ascentium for Enterprise at ascentium.com.

5. Documents to gather

- ☐ **Passport for every director and shareholder**
- ☐ **Proof of residential address from the last 3 months**
- ☐ **Proposed company name and business activity (SSIC code)**
- ☐ **Share capital and shareholding split**
- ☐ **For corporate shareholders: certificate of incorporation and board resolution**

6. How Ascentium helps

AI compliance dashboard	A live compliance score for every entity, with each filing, deadline and document in one view.
Ascentia, AI voice assistant	Ask about your status, deadlines or a change, 24/7, and get a qualified expert when judgement is needed.
Premium Economy fare	Incorporation, secretary, registered address, bookkeeping, financial statements and Form C-S in one indicative fee from S$1,490 a year.
Switching is easy	Moving from another provider? We take over registers and records and file the change for you.